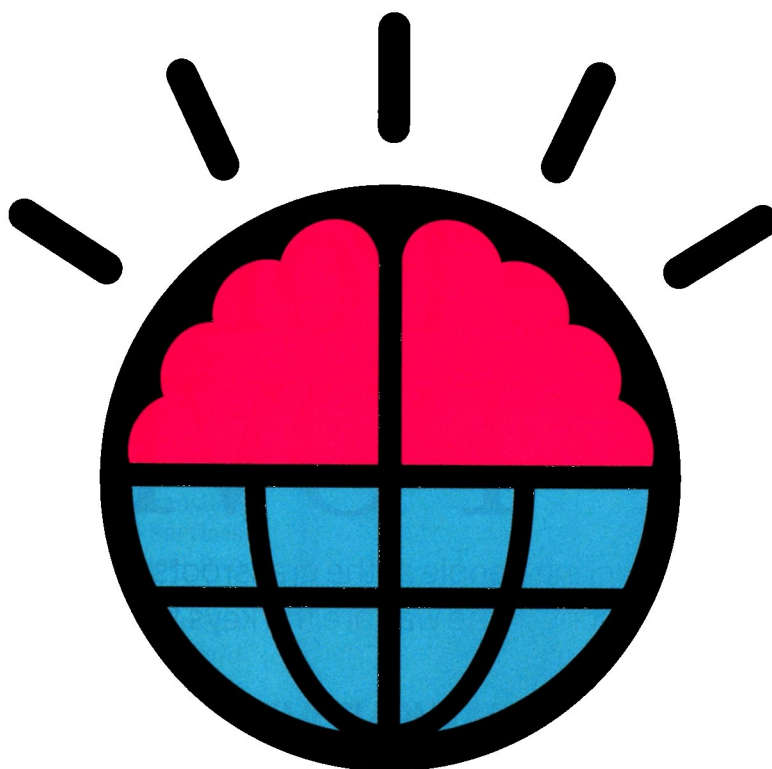




A new intelligence for a smarter planet.

Every leader makes decisions. And every decision depends on information. That holds as true for someone leading a company, as it does for someone leading a country.

Over the past few years, the quantity and quality of information available to leaders has undergone a revolution, even as the Information Age set in and the basis of competition shifted to knowledge, expertise and intellectual capital. Indeed, the true value of information technology has never been about chips, computers or software. Rather, it is the ability to help leaders understand what has happened, is happening and may yet happen.

But this level of understanding is becoming even harder to develop, as the sheer volume of data explodes on a planet where information is being authored by billions of people and flowing from a trillion intelligent devices, sensors and instrumented objects. About 80% of this new data growth is unstructured content, such as e-mail documents, audio and video. And because transactions are occurring so rapidly, systems may have to take in, correlate and analyze event information in real time, more than 60,000 times a second.

But does that mean we must simply resign ourselves to coping with blind spots that keep growing larger?

Happily, no. The technology exists to help capture and process all this data and turn it into actual intelligence. We can spot patterns with unprecedented detail, assimilate and analyze changes in markets, faster than ever before.

New approaches such as 'stream computing' use advanced software algorithms to track, correlate and analyze information and then plug it directly into operational systems, closing the gap between thinking and doing.

This has the potential to change how the world literally works. Insurance companies are seeing the patterns in billions of claims, and can better identify the few that are fraudulent. Police departments are correlating information from multiple sources to identify crime patterns – helping prevent crime, in addition to fighting it.

Retail, manufacturing, agriculture, government, medicine – the list is long and the change is just starting. Imagine how it will transform all the things we seek in business and society – economic growth, societal progress, environmental sustainability and cures for diseases.

Let's build a smarter planet. Join us, and see what others are thinking, at ibm.com/smarterplanet/In/Intelligence